



BSc (Hons) in **Computer Science**
SE3062 : Intelligent Systems

Year 3 · Semester 1 · 2026 Semester 2

Faculty of Computing

Practical 02

Objective & Lecture Mapping: In Lecture 03, we learned that a mathematically perfect "Table-Driven Agent" is impossible to build due to combinatorial explosion. Instead, we must write Agent Programs. Today, you will implement a **Simple Reflex Agent** using Condition-Action rules, observe its fatal flaws in a partially observable environment, and then upgrade it to a **Model-Based Agent** that maintains an internal memory state.

Part 1: Practical Implementation — Coding the Architectures

Step 1.1: Setting the Trap (Partial Observability)

To see why Simple Reflex agents fail, we must handicap your agent's sensors. We are moving from a Fully Observable world to a Partially Observable one.

1. Open your `visual_grid_game.py` from Lab 01.
2. Locate the `get_percept(self)` method.
3. Modify it so it **no longer returns** the exact global coordinates (`agent_pos`). Instead, it should only return local booleans, e.g., `{'wall_ahead': True/False, 'food_here': True/False}` based on checking the adjacent cell in its current facing direction.

Step 1.2: The Simple Reflex Agent (Implementation & Failure)

1. Create a new class called `SimpleReflexAgent` .
2. Implement a `sense_and_act(self, percept)` method that uses strictly IF-THEN logic (Condition-Action rules). *Do not use an `__init__` method to store history.*

Example Logic: IF food_here THEN suck; IF wall_ahead THEN turn_left; ELSE move_forward

3. Run the simulation. **Observe:** Watch the agent get trapped in a corner or a U-shaped wall, infinitely repeating a cycle (e.g., turn left, step forward, hit wall, turn left...).

Step 1.3: The Model-Based Agent (Memory & State)

1. Create a new class called `ModelBasedAgent`.
2. Implement an `__init__(self)` method to initialize an internal memory state (e.g., `self.visited_cells = set()` or a relative movement tracker).
3. In `sense_and_act(self, percept)`, first **update the state** (Transition & Sensor Model) by recording the current percept and the last action taken.
4. Update your IF-THEN rules to query the memory.
Example Logic: IF wall_ahead AND left_is_visited THEN turn_right
5. Run the simulation. **Observe:** The agent should now remember where it has been, realize it is in a loop, and choose an alternate path to escape.

Part 2: Theoretical Evaluation & Lecture Mapping

Based on your practical observations above, answer the following questions to map your code directly to the architectural theories covered in Lecture 02.

1. (Remember) According to Lecture 02, why is it impossible to program a mathematically perfect "Table-Driven Agent" for complex environments like Chess? What happens as the agent's lifetime increases?

A mathematically perfect Table Driven Agent is impractical for complex environments such as Chess because it would need to store every possible percept sequence and the corresponding action. The number of possible situations increases extremely quickly, causing a combinatorial explosion in the size of the table.

As the agent's lifetime increases, the number of possible percept sequences continues to grow. Therefore, the table would require an unrealistic amount of memory and computation, making it impossible to construct and maintain in practice.

2. (Understand) Look at the code you wrote for your `SimpleReflexAgent` . Identify and explain the specific lines of code that represent the "Condition-Action Rules" discussed in the lecture.

The condition action rules are the IF THEN statements in the SimpleReflexAgent. The first rule checks if food is present and then performs the Eat action. The second rule checks if there is a wall ahead and then performs the TurnLeft action. If neither condition is true, the agent performs the MoveForward action. These rules make decisions using only the current percept without using memory or previous percepts.

3. (Analyze) Your `SimpleReflexAgent` likely got stuck in an infinite loop during Step 1.2. Based on the lecture, analyze exactly why this happened. How did the combination of "Partial Observability" and a lack of "Percept History" cause this failure?

The Simple Reflex Agent got stuck because it only uses the current percept and has no memory of previous situations. Since the environment is partially observable, the agent cannot see the complete environment or know its exact position. When it reaches the same situation again, it applies the same condition action rule as before. Without percept history, it cannot recognize that it has already visited the same area, so it can repeatedly turn and move in the same cycle, resulting in an infinite loop.

4. (Evaluate) In Step 1.3, you added an internal state to your `ModelBasedAgent` . Evaluate how your specific code handles the "Transition Model" (how the world evolves) and the "Sensor Model" (how the agent's actions affect the world).

The Model Based Agent uses the Sensor Model to receive information from the environment through percepts such as whether there is food or a wall ahead. It uses the Transition Model to update its internal position and direction based on the actions it takes. The agent also stores visited states in memory, allowing it to remember previous situations and choose different actions when it detects a repeated state.

Finalize and Lock Lab 02 Documentation

Incomplete: 0/11 questions answered. Please provide detailed responses for all questions.



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